

LACHAM NEWS

No. 4

May 1981

CUB SECTION

On Saturday 28th March the Pack was well represented at a Cross Country event at Tatsfield and were placed 4th overall with our under 9 years of age team winning their age group. Good individual performances from Richard White, Gary Dring and Neil Roffey in their respective age groups. On the football field we drew 5-5 with the Pack from Bletchingley on 5th April and were well and truly defeated by Lingfield Oak Pack in our last league match on 12th April by 18-1. Our scorers in the first game were Gary Dring (2), Anthony Wiseman, Stephen Nixon and Chris Rebbeck; our solitary goal scorer in the Lingfield match was Anthony with a penalty. Congrats etc to both Wayne McClean and Neil Roffey on again being selected for the Cubs District Team.

The Pack annual outing was held on 15th April. This year we went to the HMS Belfast and the Tower of London. The weather stayed fine for us, thankfully. Daniel Walker's cap decided that it liked the look of the Thames more than Daniel's head and was last seen floating away between the Bank and the Belfast. Apart from this minor mishap we all enjoyed the day out.

Jeremy Upton has left the Pack having moved to Kent - our very best wishes go with him. Silver Arrows have been awarded to Gary Dring and Stephen Strudwick. Well done both of you and also congrats to Neil Roffey who has inherited the Senior Sixer woggle. Our four newcomers, Kurt Cormack, Alexander Godden, Nicholas Jones and Karl Wick have been presented with the Cub Scout Badges.

John Axtell

CSL.

VISIT TO THE SCOUT CAMPSITE

IN WALES

On the 1st March a group of P.L.'s plus Nigel King (who was standing in a P.L. for Lions) and Skip, Coxon, Bosun and Akela went to Wales to inspect the campsite for the 1981 Summer camp.

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We set off at 6 am in Skip's and Coxun's car. We made for the M4 which we remained on for almost all the way. We stopped once at Membury for a rest and a 'Leek' (St. David's Day) then our next stop was the campsite. When we arrived we met the owner Mr. Williams who directed us to the campsite which was about a mile away from his home. The campsite was along a narrow winding road. When we looked around the campsite it was raining of course (typical Welsh weather) and Wellies were the order of the day. The campsite was excellent in most ways, it was very flat, well drained, it had a stream running along one side and a canal across the top, suitable for canoeing.

The only snag was that the water tap was about a $\frac{1}{4}$ mile away and firewood was rather scarce. The field was perfect for all sports because of its flatness and its short mossy grass.

After seeing the campsite and being most impressed we went to see Llangorse Lake. After that we went up a narrow winding mountain road for lunch. We found a grassy clearing to eat lunch and after lunch, Coxun had some difficulties getting off the slippery grass. Eventually he got off and we made our way down into the valley. We rejoined the motorway at about 2pm and at about 4pm we stopped at Membury for a bite to eat and a P.L.'s discussion about various confidential matters. We arrived home at about 7.30pm after an enjoyable St. David's Day in Wales.

Richard Goodell
Scout.

RETURN VISIT TO THE 38th CROYDON TROOP CAMP NEAR BIGGIN HILL

One weekend about two months ago 9 lads from the troop went on a camp (in huts luckily), with two other troops, the 38th and 48th Croydons. The Campsite was at Downe, near Biggin Hill. Everyone was put in patrols which were called, Super Eagles, Specials, Dirty (Dingle) Dens and Yorkies.

The weekend was enjoyable apart from three things:-

1. The weather was awful as it rained all weekend.
2. The providore was only open for 20 minutes all weekend.
3. A leader called Yo (we nicknamed him Grumpy), who confiscated items off unwary campers eg myself (cards), Gavin Chippinton (Radio).

The activities included Compass work, Decoding messages, Comando raids, First aid water line and a crazy football competition in 3 feet of mud! There was a golf course

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at the foot of the hill and a few golf balls were found.
At the end of the camp the positions (with members) of the
patrols were:-
1st Specials - James Fox, Edgar Furman, George Padelopoulos.

2nd - Yorkies - Gavin Chippington, Simon Weaverfalck

3rd - Super Eagles - Richard Goodall, Graham Jakes.

4th - Dirty Dans - Warren Jakes, Darrell Law.

in the end we came to the conclusion that the best
part of the camp was going home.

Warren Jakes.
Scout.

FROM THE UNIT

Most of our programme during April was taken up with
training for the Dartmoor Expeditions, sessions
included what equipment is necessary and how to use it,
dangers of walking in open country and on Exposure.
We had 17 Venture Scouts walking and 3 leading as
invigilators. Two of the Unit were completing Queens
Scout Award Expeditions and the remainder Venture
Scout Awards Expeditions. This all took part over the
Easter holiday weekend and turned out to be very
successful - as did the weather

We also took up an invite to cater at a motor cycle
meeting in East Grinstead which turned out to be very
enlightening - we had a visit by a Public Health
Inspector! We didn't exactly make a profit but had
a laugh or two and became wiser for any future event.

We were delighted this month to invest two of the
Unit, Celia Brown and Philip Clarke.

Next month will be our first weekend sailing on Spirit of
Discovery - more about it next time.

Ray Fox
Venture Scout Leader

HMS BELFAST AND THE TOWER

OF LONDON

On the 15th April 1st Lagham Cubs went to see HMS Belfast
in London. As we walked down the street from London
Bridge Station towards the Balfast, we saw three hot air

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balloons in the shape of airships. We had to wait a quarter of an hour so we sat on a wall by the River Thames and had something to eat. During this Daniel Walker's cap found its way into the River followed by somebody's apple.

Once on the Belfast we went to a cabin and saw a film about the ship. After the film Wayne McClean tried on a helmet and gloves which the gunners used to wear. The guide showed us two shells and told us that the ship has six nine inch guns and nine six inch guns. When the guide had finished Akela said we could wander around the ship. I bought an ice cream and looked over the bridge, Captains cabin and then the ships canteen where you could buy a cake for 2d. We also saw the gun room, Doctor's quarters and the ship cells. Left the Belfast over the river by ferry to see the Tower of London. The first thing we noticed were The Beefeaters and the many cannons laying about. We visited the White Tower and saw over the one hundred pieces of armout with lots of guns and swords. As we came out the guards were changing. Next we saw the Crown Jewels which are protected by six inch steel doors. One of the Gold Cross was missing, but we were told that the Queen was using it. After a visit to the souvenir shop we caught the underground to Victoria and then by train home via Redhill.

Anthony Wiseman

Cub.

DATES

1. Our annual Group Gang Shows have been enjoyed both by audiences and cast. Those cubs, scouts and venture scouts who have enjoyed performing at our Shows, now have an opportunity to appear in next years District Pantomime. Those interested should contact Skip or Mr. Alan Osbourne (Smallfield 3489).

2. Congratulations to patrol leader Andrew Duff on winning his age group section of the County Scouts Cyclocross at High Ashurst, Box Hill. He even managed to get his name published in 'Surrey Scout' - (see noticeboard!) This year was the inaugural event but in view of its success it has already been decided to hold a county cyclocross in 1982.

CHEESE AND WINE

12th May

Don't forget our Wine and Cheese evening at HQ on

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Tuesday 12th May. It would be nice to see all parents and friends coming along. Patrol leaders and venture scouts also welcome.

The evening starts at 7.30pm and our new extension will be open and on show. During the evening we shall devote about half an hour to our Annual General Meeting.

Tickets are not required - just turn up and enjoy yourselves. Please support this social evening - we would love to see you and also all friends of the group. Children are welcome with parents.

DON'T FORGET!!

Skip.

If you know of anyone who has a mini bus they would kindly lend us please contact Skip. This will be used for Scout Camp and will be greatly needed.

Next edition of Newsletter will be 24th May when the editors would like entries to be handed in.

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